Contact

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www.linkedin.com/in/neal-oswald-1061895 (LinkedIn)
www.wanilah.com (Company)

Top Skills

Change Execution
Business Innovation
Governance, Risk Management, and Compliance (GRC)

Certifications

CA
CFA
CMC
ICD.D
CPA

Neal Oswald

Fintech Advisor & Board Director | Turning Strategy into Execution at Scale | Digital & Operational Transformation, ICD.D
Torrance, Ontario, Canada

Summary

Founder & Principal AdvisorWanilah Advisors helps banks, credit unions, fintechs, and financial services organizations navigate the intersection of artificial intelligence, payments modernization, digital transformation, risk management, and growth strategy.Selected advisory areas include:• AI strategy and implementation roadmaps• Banking and operating model transformation• Payments modernization and real-time payments readiness• Open banking and API ecosystem strategy• Embedded finance partnerships• Customer experience transformation• Risk, governance, and regulatory readiness• Executive and board education on emerging technologiesWorking with leadership teams to turn strategic opportunities into measurable business outcomes.

Experience

Peoples Group
Board Member
August 2026 - Present (3 months)
Toronto, Calgary, Vancouver

Board Member Peoples Group

Wanilah Advisors Inc
Senior Advisor to Fintechs, Board Member, Executive Coach, ICD.D
January 2022 - Present (4 years 10 months)
North America

StereoLogic (SL), Senior Advisor, https://stereologic.com/

Working with StereoLOGIC to deliver process transparency and insight into business processes to rapidly enable automation and digitization. Working as part of their customer advisory board.

Holt Xchange: Member of a group of advisors, and limited partner, who support Holt Xchange group of portfolio fintech ventures. https://holtxchange.com/

Senior Advisor, Asset Direct https://www.assetdirect.io/
Working with Asset Direct as investor and consultant to create the world's first truly global network of financial sales agents where hundreds of thousands of global partners drive traffic to thousands of financial institutions across the world.

Seedwell, Banking Advisory Board Member, https://www.seedwell.io/

Seedwell is a full spectrum solution for employee personal finance and financial literacy. Seedwell’s AI platform automates personal finance, right from payroll. The heart of Seedwell is a unique Automated Income Allocation (AIA) algorithm that ensures that every dollar is sent to the most efficient accounts to maximize wealth.

DarkConsulting, Senior Advisor, https://www.darkconsultinggroup.com/

A boutique consulting firm focussed on the CU sector that just gets work done!

Credx, Ownest.ai, Senior Advisor, https://www.ownest.ai/

Credx: a closed loop embedded finance platform originating merchant receivables. Ownest: Automated onboarding, underwriting and document verification platform that significantly improves the end client experience while also reducing manual work risk and fraud.

AGM Risk 360
Senior Business Advisor
November 2024 - Present (2 years)
Wanilah Island Muskoka

AGM Risk Management – A group of Credit Default Waterfall (CDW) risk, technology and legal professionals. We have created valuation and analytical engines, to assess the impact of processing and compliance errors in Mortgage Default, Loss Mitigation, Loan Modification, Bankruptcy and Foreclosures in all phases of the CDW. We see rising foreclosures, and bankruptcies at rates exceeding the global financial crisis. We help mortgage servicers, banks, investors and borrowers manage and remediate this risk. This risk is pervasive and will impact bank capital ratios, mbs valuations and most importantly the financial health of borrowers and their families.

wanilah advisors.com

Co-Founder

February 2015 - Present (11 years 9 months)

http://www.wanilah.com/

Founder & Principal Advisor

Wanilah Advisors helps banks, credit unions, fintechs, and financial services organizations navigate the intersection of artificial intelligence, payments modernization, digital transformation, risk management, and growth strategy.

Selected advisory areas include:

- AI strategy and implementation roadmaps
- Banking and operating model transformation
- Payments modernization and real-time payments readiness
- Open banking and API ecosystem strategy
- Embedded finance partnerships
- Customer experience transformation
- Risk, governance, and regulatory readiness
- Executive and board education on emerging technologies

Working with leadership teams to turn strategic opportunities into measurable business outcomes.

Wyth Financial

COO and SVP

August 2018 - December 2021 (3 years 5 months)

Canada

Working collaboratively with our ecosystem partners and credit unions to compete in the digital economy. We have launched Canada's first truly digital Challenger Bank - Wyth Financial https://wyth.ca/

decide.solutions

Professional Services Lead

July 2017 - November 2019 (2 years 5 months)

Orange County, California, United States

Decide & Co. are a firm of senior experienced digital age trust enablers. We are building a Digital Trust Identity Consortium so that individuals can "own their own" identity. We are also building a "Conduct Authority" to support firms who are serious about building and restoring trust in the digital age. Our professional services team works to protect firms using an evidence based

approach through the intelligent use of technology and risk quantification techniques while working with leadership teams to build operationally excellent firms to change behaviour, culture, ethics and performance to deliver a "conduct advantage". Trust is the only sustainable competitive advantage; building trust is a multidimensional problem that starts with effective leadership and vision.

We help build the most trusted organizations by focusing on the client and the employee to deliver as promised.

Smashblock Corp.

Solution Delivery Lead at Smashblock

December 2016 - August 2018 (1 year 9 months)

Greater Toronto Area, Canada

Smashblock helps organizations change the way they change. We use innovative technology and iterative execution cycles to execute complex multidimensional change on an end to end basis. We start with our clients' client to design the change to engage the client by enabling and empowering employees. Our methodology and approach truly engages the minds and passion of our clients. We are seasoned execution specialists with a passion to just get it done.

CIBC

6 years

Senior Vice President Process Management for Retail Banking

June 2013 - April 2015 (1 year 11 months)

Toronto

Lead Process Management for Retail & Business Banking focusing on End to End (ETE) processes to deliver client centric operational excellence to accelerate profitable revenue growth and enhance Cibc's client experience.

Senior Vice President Process Management, Technology and Operations

August 2012 - June 2013 (11 months)

Toronto Ontario

Working to deliver End to End (ETE) process management and measurement at CIBC. Also responsible for CIBC's EPMO and Secretary of the Strategic Project Office (SPO).

Senior Vice President Strategic Planning and Business Management

December 2010 - August 2012 (1 year 9 months)

Greater Toronto Area, Canada

Responsible for working across technology and operations to better align technology and operations with the business. Provided thought leadership regarding business and operational effectiveness, controls and risk. Secretary of the Strategic Project Office (SPO). Worked through the SPO to align project spending and execution priorities with CIBC's strategy and business partner priorities. Worked to establish COE's in strategic workforce management, EPMO, outsourcing/bpo governance and process management. Also worked to improve risk, operational, management and board reporting across T&O.

SVP and CFO Wholesale Bank and Treasury
July 2009 - January 2011 (1 year 7 months)
Greater Toronto Area, Canada

CFO for the Wholesale bank and Treasury. Managed several large change initiatives across the division as it restructured in the wake of the financial crisis. Also worked with the management team as the CAO to address many process, operational and technology issues to reposition the investment bank, treasury and trading room for growth.

SVP and CFO CIBC World Markets
2009 - January 2011 (2 years)
Greater Toronto Area, Canada

CFO for the Wholesale bank. Managed several large change initiatives across the division as it restructured in the wake of the financial crisis. Also worked with the management team as the CAO to address many process, operational and technology issues to reposition the investment bank and trading room for growth.

Wanilah Advisors
Co founder
July 2008 - January 2009 (7 months)
Greater Toronto Area, Canada

Wanilah Advisors provides, large scale transformation, change execution, thought leadership and capital markets and risk management advisory services.

PricewaterhouseCoopers
Partner
July 2005 - July 2008 (3 years 1 month)
Greater Toronto Area, Canada

Former leader Banking and Capital Markets Advisory Practice

Electronic Data Systems

Leader Global Risk Management Practice

March 2003 - May 2005 (2 years 3 months)

Global role

Lead a global risk management advisory practice for EDS. Working across their 4B $ FS Outsourcing business to deliver AML/KYC, Risk Management and Fraud solutions

Cap Gemini Ernst & Young

Vice President

2001 - 2003 (2 years)

Greater Toronto Area, Canada

Lead the Financial Services practice for Cap Gemini in Canada after it was sold by Ernst & Young

Ernst & Young

Partner

1995 - 2001 (6 years)

Lead Financial Services Consulting Practice in Canada

Lead Risk Management Consulting Practice in Canada

Worked at EY to get my CA and audit FS clients.

Prior to the sale to Cap Gemini ~ 20 years of professional work in FS and risk management technology deployment and change execution

Education

University of Toronto - Rotman School of Management

Directors Education Program , Board Governance, ESG, DEI, Role of a Director · (January 2021 - October 2021)

The University of Western Ontario - Richard Ivey School of Business

Honours Business Administration, Business · (1978 - 1982)

Erindale Secondary

High School Diploma, Maths, Science and English · (1974 - 1978)